

Orient Cement: Building the foundations of digital transformation on RISE with SAP on Google Cloud

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ABOUT ORIENT CEMENT



Orient Cement completed a full-fledged migration to RISE with SAP within months and launched a data-driven decision-making strategy with Google Cloud.

About Orient Cement

Part of the CK Birla Group, Orient Cement is one of the fastest growing cement manufacturers in India, driving a mission of quality and sustainability. Focused on resilience and durability, the company has set benchmarks in the industry with its product excellence. Orient Cement is one of the only two Indian cement companies to be awarded the Total Plant Maintenance Excellence Award by the Japan Institute of Plant Maintenance. The company has also received multiple awards for green and

Google Cloud results

- Enables cloud-based digital transformation by boosting ERP performance through migration to RISE with SAP
- Opens path to unlimited data insights
- Frees engineering team to focus on creative application building by saving hours weekly in mundane chores

In India, the monsoon season brings heavy rains that disrupt work on building sites through September. For Orient Cement (<https://orientcement.com/orient-cement/>)

leading cement manufacturers, the rain in business provided a window to carry out a comprehensive

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safety practices, including GreenPro Certification by the Confederation of Indian Industry.

Industries: Manufacturing

Location: India



About RISE with SAP

RISE with SAP transitions an enterprise's current ERP data and processes to the cloud with less risk and without compromise. The bundle of tailor-made ERP software, transformation services, business analytics, and partner expertise guides users along a personalized path to the cloud. The business-transformation-as-a-service offers companies a completely new way to redesign processes for better business outcomes.

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Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>)
as-a-service offers companies a

SAP on Google Cloud

(<https://cloud.google.com/solutions/sap/>)

digital transformation to a cloud-first operation that leverages machine learning (ML) for data insight.

Specifically, Orient Cement sought to move its enterprise resource planning (ERP) systems on SAP ECC

(https://help.sap.com/docs/HANA_SMART_DATA_INTEGRATION/7952ef28a6914997abc01745fef1b607/80d06249cae450daa34ea753d2051b5.html)

in an on-premise environment, to a cloud-based one on RISE with SAP

(<https://www.sap.com/products/rise.html>) that would live on Google Cloud (<https://cloud.google.com/>). In the transition to SAP's business transformation-as-a-service platform, the company also sought to move its data to a data warehouse to launch ML projects that would help optimize business decision-making from procurement to logistics.

The company that is part of the multi-billion dollar CK Birla Group had an urgent need to carry out the ambitious ERP and data migration within 3.5 months to coincide with the end of monsoon season, when India's construction industry leaps back into frenetic activity. Timely execution, says Karthick Raja, Chief Information Officer, Orient Cement, was "mission critical" because of the company's overwhelming reliance on SAP systems in every aspect of its business.

"I would say 60 to 70 percent of our business operations are dependent on SAP," he says. "If SAP stops, the complete business stops, my deliveries stop. I can't even send the material outside our plants. So it was imperative the job got done by the

end of September when business picks up after the monsoons as per the requirement of MD and CEO/Leadership of the company."

Creative partnerships for RISE with SAP driven intelligent business transformation

Working closely with the SAP and Google Cloud teams, Orient Cement succeeded in carrying out a full-fledged migration to RISE with SAP with zero glitches as the building season resumed, just in time to benefit from ERP modernization. RISE with SAP brings solutions from SAP and technology ecosystem partners into one end-to-end offering. This includes business process intelligence and enterprise networks to enable smart business transformation.

"We are the first Cement Company in India to adopt Rise with SAP. Three-and-a-half months for migration was a very aggressive target," says Karthick Raja. "We achieved the primary objective of moving to RISE with SAP with time to spare. This would not have been possible without Google Cloud implementation, which significantly reduces the risks of migration thanks to system resilience."

He adds that the company also faced the challenge of migrating terabytes of data from SAP to RISE with SAP on Google Cloud. This was achieved in the required time-frame and Orient Cement went overnight from an on-premise operation to having up to 70 percent of company data on the cloud in RISE with SAP.

The transformation set the stage for a future data transformation program to build a data warehouse for both SAP and non SAP workloads and leverage AI to transform its business. Overall, the support enabled Orient Cement to become the first cement company in India to carry out RISE with SAP migration.

"Google Cloud partnered with us to run education programs. They gave us different learning paths, such as network learning, security protocols, data learning paths," says Karthick Raja. "We ran a two-month program to keep the team also learning so that we could fully ready the team's potential for future data transformation programs, which will yield data insights far into the future."

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*—Karthick Raja, Chief
Information Officer, Orient
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Unlocking a blueprint for cement industry transformation with advanced ERP technology

Orient Cement identified three pillars for innovation that it considers as a holistic roadmap for the company's digital future.

First, it sees itself as a cloud-first manufacturing company. Next, it seeks to embrace data-driven approaches to decision making. Lastly, it plans to achieve "platformization" of all business units, such as logistics and sales, through deployment of APIs. This will lead to value chain optimization for the cement business, underpinned by built-in security features offered by Google Cloud.

"Our strategic business pillars become the guiding principle for our digital transformation over the next three years," says Karthick Raja. "The operational efficiencies and data insight enabled by our RISE with SAP migration on Google Cloud will be a powerful engine of this strategy, as we build smart manufacturing into our business."

Through this roadmap, Orient Cement seeks to drive significant cost savings, operational efficiencies, quality and compliance improvements, and revenue gains through the smart application ecosystem furnished by RISE with SAP on Google Cloud. While it is too early to gauge the success of the system for Orient Cement, research shows that RISE with SAP on Google Cloud brings companies (https://services.google.com/fh/files/misc/sap_rise_with_google_cloud_brief.pdf) an average of \$7.1 million in legacy system savings and \$1.3 million in end-user productivity gains.

Already, the team is experiencing major benefits from the transition. Since migration, Orient Cement has been able to improve its SAP performance. Meanwhile, the company is freed from the chore of managing on-premise infrastructure and application

configurations, so they can spend their time focusing on other creative tasks.

"RISE with SAP helped free our creative capabilities from day one. I'm not worried about developing a skill set, or building a team internally to manage or develop infrastructure," says Karthick Raja. "Now we have the ability to focus on core business functionalities. That's thanks to moving from on-prem infrastructure management to cloud-based management where SAP takes care of everything."

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Unlimited future of data-driven manufacturing with Vertex AI

Orient Cement foresees turning the firm into a leader of data-driven decision-making in India's manufacturing sector. Karthick Raja says the plan is to monitor what business needs arise, from manufacturing to sales and fleet logistics. This will help it identify specific use cases to drive ML-driven data insight that can ultimately save costs and generate revenue gains.

Karthick Raja feels confident with Google Cloud knowing they have in-country data residency and disaster recovery capabilities. As next steps, Orient Cement plans to leverage Google Cloud BigQuery Data warehouse and Vertex AI

(<https://cloud.google.com/vertex-ai>) to build powerful

algorithms to drive automated optimizations across the value chain, starting from the integrated supply chain and driving sales.

"We're excited to identify the use cases where Vertex AI is going to help, such as our dealer churn prediction for sales," says Karthick Raja. "While building foundational capabilities, we're deep in an exploratory phase with SAP and Google Cloud teams from which we expect digital business transformation to grow organically."

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